

FAQs: Application Form

Summary of the Application Form FAQ page of the Passport Seva portal

Source

Page: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/FaqApplicationForm>

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About this document: a plain-language summary written from the pages above. It is not a verbatim copy and not an official publication. The site's content belongs to the Ministry of External Affairs, Government of India; always confirm details on the official site before acting.

This is the "Application Form" category of the site's FAQs: 28 questions in six groups. Questions and answers are restated in plain language and in the same order as on the page.

Application form overview

1. What passport services are there, and which one do I apply under?

- **Fresh passport:** your first application in that passport category.
- **Re-issue:** another passport in place of an existing one, because:
 - personal particulars have changed
 - validity expired within the last 3 years or is due to expire (the page words this as "within next 10 years")
 - validity expired more than 3 years ago
 - the pages are used up
 - the passport is damaged
 - the passport is lost
- **Category rule:** if you have never held an Ordinary passport you apply as Fresh, even if you hold an Official or Diplomatic one. The same holds in reverse for Official and Diplomatic passports.
- **Miscellaneous services:**
 - Police Clearance Certificate (PCC)
 - Background verification for the U.S. Global Entry Program (GEP), for Indian citizens enrolled with U.S. Customs and Border Protection
 - Surrender Certificate, for people handing in their passport at a Passport Office on renouncing Indian citizenship and taking a foreign nationality
 - Line of Control (LoC) permits, issued by the Passport Offices at Jammu and Srinagar to residents of the Union Territories of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh visiting relatives across the LoC
 - Certificate of Identity, for stateless persons, including Tibetan refugees living in India

Main application form

2. My passport has no surname and my full name sits in the Given Name field. How do I add the surname?

The site's answer is general. Applicants type in their own data and can check it again at Counter A of the PSK or POPSK, so it asks for care at that stage. If the printed booklet does not match the form you submitted, return the passport to the Regional Passport Office concerned for correction. If the correction is approved, a new booklet with a new passport number is issued. Any extra fee depends on the merits of the case, and in some cases you may be told to apply for re-issue.

Police Clearance Certificate (PCC) form

3. Can one application cover a PCC for more than one country?

No. Each application gets a PCC for one country only.

Background verification for the U.S. Global Entry Program (GEP)

4. What is the Global Entry Program?

A Trusted Traveller programme run by U.S. Customs and Border Protection (CBP). Pre-approved, low-risk travellers get faster clearance on arrival in the United States through dedicated lanes and kiosks. Indian citizens are eligible. Details: <https://www.cbp.gov/travel/trusted-traveler-programs/global-entry>

5. What is background verification for GEP, and when do I need it?

It is a miscellaneous service on Passport Seva: a check of the passport and a police or criminality check for Indian citizens enrolling in GEP. If you have applied to CBP for GEP, you apply for this verification through Passport Seva to get clearance from the Regional Passport Office of your choice. The form can be filled in online on the portal.

6. How do I apply for it?

First apply for GEP through CBP's Global Online Enrollment System (GOES), <https://goes-app.cbp.dhs.gov/>. Then log in to Passport Seva and apply for "Background Verification for GEP". You need your GOES ID, and only one verification application can be submitted per GOES ID. Steps: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/ApplyGEP>

7. Do I have to visit a PSK to submit it?

Yes. You book an appointment and visit the PSK.

8. Which documents do I take to the PSK?

- Original passport, with self-attested photocopies of the first two and last two pages. Include the ECR/Non-ECR page, any page carrying an observation by the Passport Issuing Authority, and the validity extension page of a short validity passport.
- Proof of present address, if it differs from the address in the passport
- PAN card

9. How do I find out the status after submitting?

You cannot get it from Passport Seva. The verification is an internal arrangement between U.S. CBP and the PSP Division of the MEA, and its status is not disclosed to applicants for security reasons. Ask U.S. CBP about your application.

Diplomatic/Official form

10. Must I fix a photograph to the printed Diplomatic/Official form, and to what specification?

Yes. Bring two colour photographs, 4.5 x 3.5 cm, on a white background, and fix them to the printed copy of the online form.

- First photograph: page 1, with no signature or stamp.
- Second photograph: page 3, stamped across with the office stamp and signed by the Head of Office.

Documents to attach to the application form

11. Do I need originals, or are certified copies enough?

Attach self-attested photocopies of every required document. Show the originals at the counter at the PSK or POPSK. They are returned once verified.

12. Is an Identity Certificate compulsory for government, public sector and statutory body employees? Can they apply as ordinary citizens without the extra documents?

They must add one of three documents, and the choice decides the police verification:

- **Annexure A**, Identity Certificate in original: passport issued without police verification
- **Annexure G**, No Objection Certificate: passport issued with police verification afterwards
- **Annexure H**, Prior Intimation letter: passport issued after police verification

13. When are Annexures A, G and H needed, and are they compulsory?

The site gives the same answer as question 12. Government, public sector and statutory body employees submit one of the three, with the same effect on police verification.

14. I work in a private bank. Do I need an Identity Certificate?

No. Only government, public sector and statutory body employees submit one.

15. Does a government employee making a major change of name need a newspaper announcement?

The site lists these additional documents for such employees:

- Gazette Notification changing the name in the applicant's department
- A fresh ID certificate in the changed name

16. Can dependents of government, public sector and statutory body employees apply in the normal way without affidavits?

- With the dependent's own Identity Certificate (Annexure A) in original, the passport is issued without police verification. For a minor dependent its validity stops at age 18.
- Without it, the passport is issued after police verification.
- Under Tatkaal with the required documents, police verification follows the issue of the passport.

17. Is a birth certificate compulsory for applicants born on or after 26 January 1989?

No. See the list of accepted proofs of date of birth: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/ListDOB>

18. Do I need a birth certificate for a re-issue?

The site refers you to the Document Advisor on the home page.

19. I am salaried and income tax is deducted from my pay. What do I submit for Non-ECR status?

Either of the following for Non-ECR (formerly ECNR) status:

- Proof of income tax assessment and of actual payment of income tax for the last year
- The income tax return statement for the last year, showing tax paid by you and stamped by the income tax authorities, with a copy of your PAN card

A NIL income tax return does not qualify. The full document list is in the Document Advisor on the home page.

20. What is needed when a surname changes on marriage or divorce?

No additional document is needed for a female applicant's change of surname on marriage or divorce. The full list is in the Document Advisor on the home page.

21. What if I cannot provide a marriage certificate or joint affidavit because of marital discord or separation, and am applying for a fresh passport?

Married applicants are not required to provide a marriage certificate or a joint affidavit.

22. How do I change the date or place of birth in my passport?

Apply for a re-issue and ask for the change in personal particulars. The document list is in the Document Advisor on the home page, and the competent authority may ask for more. Each case is examined individually, and the request can be refused if it is not in order.

23. Which documents do I need to change the address in my passport?

- Old passport in original, with self-attested photocopies of the first two and last two pages. Include the ECR/Non-ECR page, any observation page and the validity extension page of a short validity passport.
- Proof of present address. Accepted documents: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/ListDocuments>

24. Can I change my gender, or my father's or mother's name, in the passport?

Yes, through a re-issue with the change in personal particulars. The document list is in the Document Advisor on the home page. Each case is examined, and the request can be refused if it is not in order.

25. For Christians, Muslims and Parsis, is a marriage certificate issued by a Qazi or Church accepted as proof of marriage?

The site's answer is that married applicants are not required to provide any marriage certificate.

26. I am self-employed, recently moved from Delhi to Bangalore, and want a Tatkaal passport but have no address proof. What do I do?

Proof of address is compulsory for any passport application. Accepted documents: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/ListDocuments>

27. Can I use a bank passbook or statement as proof of address?

A bank statement is not accepted. A photo passbook of a running bank account is. The site publishes the list of banks whose passbooks are accepted:

https://www.passportindia.gov.in/AppOnlineProject/pdf/Circular_Add_Proof.pdf

28. I printed my online form and found a mistake. How do I correct it?

Ask the Citizen Service Executive at Counter A of the PSK or POPSK to make the change.

Other FAQ categories (fees, police verification, Tatkaal, lost passports and more):

<https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/faqs>